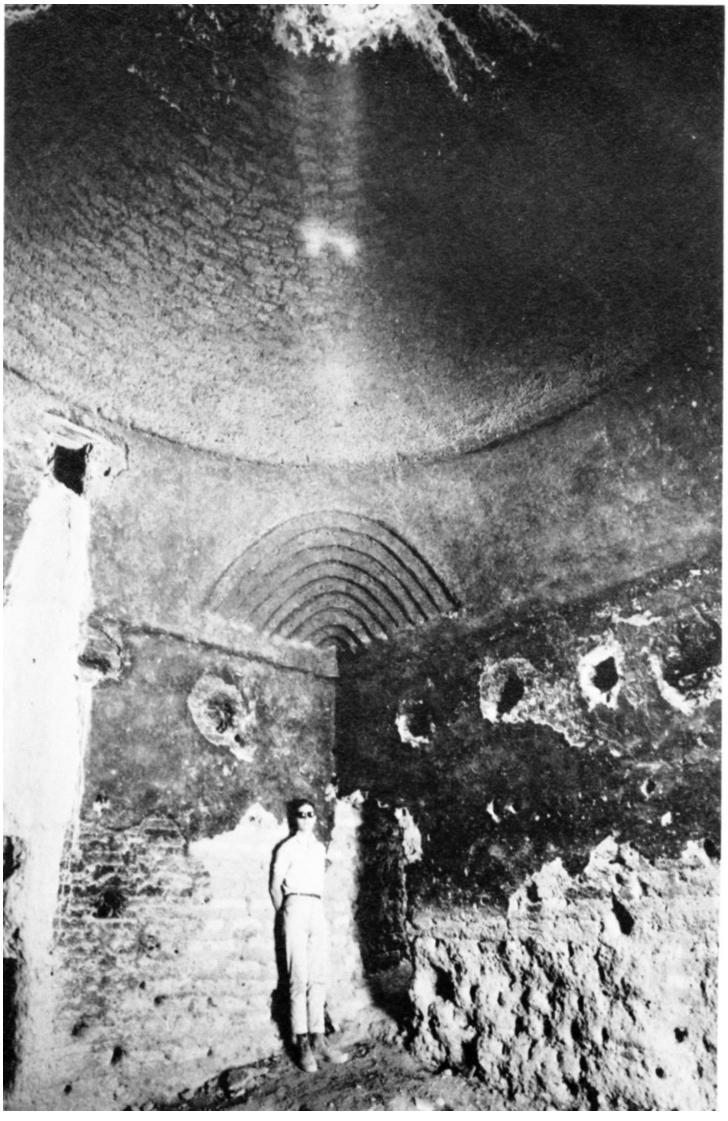


Figure 3.16 *Bamiyan vicinity, structural remains. From Le Berre 1987: pl. 87d.*

and corner bastions, was commonplace among the free-standing Buddhist monastic complexes of Central Asia, particularly of the fifth–eighth centuries, and also eminently usable for Islamic-period institutions such as *madrasa*s, palatial structures, and even fortified military garrisons. Finally, it is worth recalling that the region's great commercial prosperity and royal presence resulted in lavish architectural (and artistic) patronage throughout the second half of the first millennium CE, much of which continued to be serviceable to newcomers establishing a politico-military presence in the region. Indeed, like their predecessors, the Shansabanis had taken